

doing, instead of shutting down and then rebooting every time, you can create a shortcut on your desktop for this task in one easy step:

Right-click on your desktop, select **New > Shortcut**, and in the item location field, type in “rundll32.exe PowrProf.dll, SetSuspendState” (without the quotes), give the shortcut a descriptive name—generally “Suspend”—and click **Finish**. Now, when you want to suspend the system, just double-click this shortcut.

Irritants

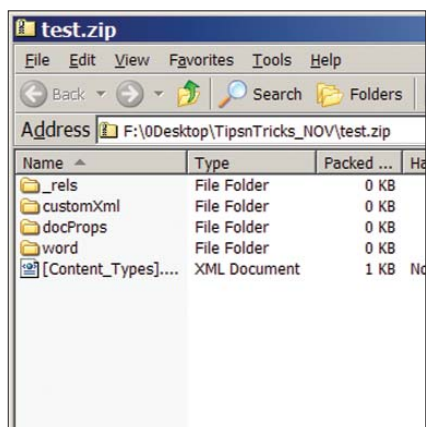
Disable Thumbnails

Windows Explorer has a feature called thumbnail view, which shows you thumbnails of all pictures in the current folder. Some people love it, others hate it. If you have pictures that you'd rather everyone around you not see, even by accident, you probably hate the thumbnail view. If so, instead of cursing at it under your breath, just get rid of it for good!

Start the Registry Editor, navigate to **HKEY_CURRENT_USER\Software\Microsoft\Windows\CurrentVersion\Explorer\Advanced**, and change the value of the **ClassicViewState** key to “1”.

No More Zip Files As Folders?

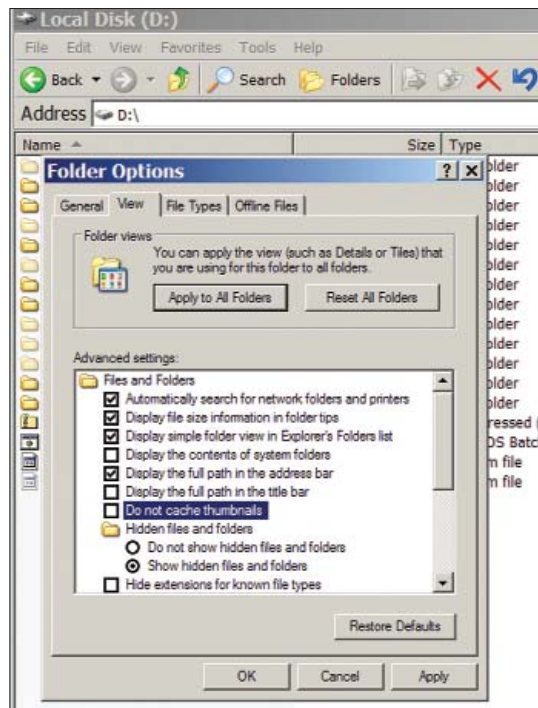
Windows XP natively supports extracting from or compressing into ZIP files. However, it treats ZIP files as folders, and if you double-click on a ZIP file, you get to see the contents, instead of unzipping it. You can prevent this from happening by running the appropriate command. Go to **Start > Run**, type in “**regsvr32 /u zipfldr.dll**” (without the quotes) and press [Enter].



In Windows XP, Explorer natively opens ZIP files like folders

Thumbs.db Irritants

It's probably happened to all of us at some point or another, especially those of us who work with a lot of



Stop XP from caching thumbnails

images: When Windows XP forgets to update a folder's Thumbs.db file after you have overwritten some image files, you end up with some wrong thumbnails associated with the wrong images.

This is because the Thumbs.db file has outdated data, and you have to delete it for Windows to get it right again. If you'd rather Windows got it right always instead of just doing it fast, you can stop the generation of Thumbs.db files altogether, forcing Windows to read every image in the folder you access, every single time.

We warn you, this is slower as Windows generates the thumbnails afresh every time.

In Windows Explorer, go to **Tools > Folder Options > View**. Look for the option called “Do not cache thumbnails” and check the box associated with it. Click **OK** and then search your entire computer for “thumbs.db”. delete all the search results once it's done searching, and you will never find another thumbs.db file on your system ever again!

Delay Desktop Cleanup

Ever so often you get this little irritating pop-up that tells you that you have unused items on your desktop, and asks whether you want to delete them. This is the Windows Desktop Cleanup Wizard, and it is set to run every 60 days by default. It's irritating to most, and feels a lot less than 60 days because of this. You can get rid of it forever by

right-clicking on the desktop, selecting **Properties**, going to the **Desktop** tab and clicking on “Customize Desktop...”. Here you will see a little checkbox that says “Run Desktop Cleanup Wizard every 60 days”; uncheck it and click **OK**.

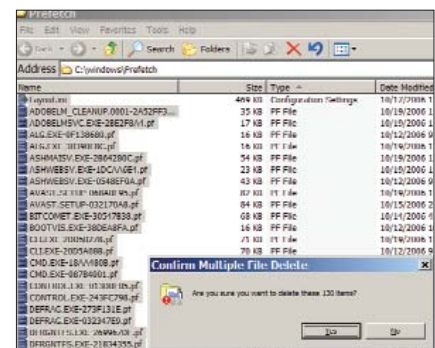
Tricks

Cleaning the Prefetch Directory

Windows XP keeps shortcuts to recently launched programs in the **\Windows\Prefetch** directory, which can take up some space, but helps find and launch applications faster. After a while, however, some really old programs which you may not even be using anymore can still be found in the Prefetch directory. Also, you may experience system slowdowns when booting or

when launching applications, because Windows is sifting through a large bunch of Prefetch files. So, as you can see, a large Prefetch can do more harm than good. It's best that you delete all the files in here about once a month, or once in two months. The first time you boot, or start applications after you delete all Prefetch files, it may be even slower than before, but this is normal: Windows is adding shortcuts and data into the Prefetch again. After the third or fourth time you boot up, things should be back to normal speeds, because Windows will have finished rebuilding the Prefetch cache.

To delete your Prefetch files, just go to **\Windows\Prefetch**, do a [Ctrl] + [A], and press [Shift] + [Delete].



Cleaning out the Prefetch clutter

Print The Directory

If you want to make a list of all the contents of a directory, you're going to have to find a much easier way